



Lake Fergus, viewed from Windy Point, Milford Road – Photo Peter Laurensen

Section News

August Section Night

At the August section night, David Ellis, founder and owner of the specialised outdoor clothing brand Earth Sea Sky, gave a fantastic talk to a large crowd at the Southern Cross. Highlighting his 35 years of experience designing and making outdoor clothing and equipment in New Zealand, David connected with the audience with his own enthusiasm for the outdoors. Through his talk, attendees learned the importance of efficient layering systems, some misunderstandings of functional clothing, and wrapped up with affirming the high calibre and practical quality of New Zealand's home grown brand.

September section night

Wednesday 6th September, 6 pm

Southern Cross, Abel Smith Street – in the back room

Wellington Section Annual Photo competition evening. Judges Nigel Roberts and Peter Laurenson will take you through this year's entries, explaining their merits and revealing category winners. Prizes will be awarded to the best photo in each category.

Categories:

1. Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high
2. Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back
3. Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way
4. Rock climbing: hardest moves, slickest lines
5. Mountain and Climbing Culture: climbing life, places and people
6. Humour: whatever gets you a laugh
7. Kids photos

New Zealand Alpine Team captain Talk

Wednesday 21st September, doors open at 7pm

TTC Hall, 4 Moncrieff Street, Mount Victoria, Wellington

Wellington Tramping and Mountaineering Club is excited to bring New Zealand Alpine Team captain Steven Fortune to give a talk about first ascents in Cordillera Blanca.

Kiwi First Ascents in Cordillera Blanca: In June a group of kiwis visited the beautiful mountain range of the Cordillera Blanca in Peru. A mixture of experience climbers and young up and coming alpinists, they climbed some classic ice and rock routes, then a number of audacious difficult first ascents culminating in the sought after West ridge of Taulliraju. Steven Fortune will talk about the trip and trekking/climbing opportunities in the area. See the [Stuff article](#) for more details.

October section night

Thursday 13th October from 6pm

Southern Cross, Abel Smith Street – in the back room

Wellington Section Annual General Meeting and movie night

Come along and have your say about the club and enjoy a selection of short movies

Please bring your koha for the section night – there'll be an ice bucket at the entry door for that purpose. 😊

Chair's Report

Well, Dave Ellis nailed it at the last section night with an insider's experience of the technical garment industry which is still being talked about in huts and on rock ledges – especially when it's raining. But the surprise was the walk down memory lane which drew out some of our old guard – a veritable who's who of the climbing world since Hillary started cutting steps. Next month it's the photo competition wrap-up. More of a short course in outdoor photography, it is a must for anyone thinking of getting a pic into the Climber or even something to hang on the wall.

My personal achievement for the month was attending the Sustainable Summits conference which was unfortunately held at Mt Cook (the weather was excellent as were conditions – a sad state of affairs for being indoors for three days). The conference exceeded expectations and attracted speakers and participants from around the world. There was a focus on topics dear to our hearts such as leaving human poo on our wilderness doorstep through to the frighteningly rapid melting of our glaciers and the challenge of overcrowding on some of our tracks. With an increase of between 10% and 15% in users of the front country, we are going to have to take some decisive action or be faced with having to climb over a wall of poo to get to the back country. Our very own Lou Sanson gave us a look at the world through the eyes of DoC and why they have increased the number of helicopter landings in the national park. The time lapse film of the retreat of the glaciers gave us a visceral look at just how fast global warming is taking place. At this rate there is likely to be a lot more cheap alpine gear on Trademe shortly. Speakers highlighted the trend toward shorter term use of the outdoors. A commercial operator noted that many are only interested in a 15 min trip, long enough to get a few photos to post on Facebook and then leave. This, in combination with a more intense working life and other demands on our time, means that our members (you) have differing interests in and expectations of your Alpine Club experience. What does the club need to do and how does it need to change to cater for this?

The NZAC national AGM is coming up. This is a chance to have a say about how the club runs and what it does. If you have any suggestions or think we should be doing things differently, make your membership count and let us know by emailing wellington@alpineclub.org.nz, tweet us @NZACWellington or post a message on Facebook www.facebook.com/nzacwellin.

Finally: "I like the mountains because they make me feel small," Jeff says. "They help me sort out what's important in life." Mark Obmascik, *Halfway to Heaven: My White-knuckled--and Knuckleheaded--Quest for the Rocky Mountain High*.

And don't forget to tell all your mates to go see REELROCK.

Simon

Chair: NZAC Wellington

Gear Hire

The Wellington section of NZAC has heaps of gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, harnesses, helmets, crampons, and probes. If you're keen to hire some gear please fill in the form [here](#). Each item costs \$5 per week.

PLB Hire

PLB hires are free, but they do require a deposit of \$50 refundable on its return. They also have a few extra steps to ensure you get help as soon as possible, should you deploy the PLB on your trip.

- Complete the gear request form [here](#).
- Email Carolyn (kaz1963@gmail.com) to find out which number PLB you have hired. You can also try her mobile 021574287 or give Simon a ring 0210547684.
- Email your trip intentions to NZACWN@gmail.com using the subject template: "PLB [#] Trip Intentions DD/MM/YYYY-DD/MM/YYYY" where the dates are the start and expected end dates of your trip. In the event you have deployed the PLB, the contacts for the PLB and possibly the Rescue Coordination Centre will access this email inbox to check what your trip intentions were.
- Arrange with Carolyn or Simon to provide your \$50 deposit and collect your PLB. Once you've returned your PLB, you will be returned your \$50 deposit.

Financial guru wanted

Our annual accounts are due to be drawn up for the financial year and we are looking for a keen volunteer to help our treasurer through the process. If you are financial whiz or even if you understand the fundamentals and can offer a bit of your time please contact the committee on wellington@alpineclub.org.nz



For quick access to the section's page on the NZAC website, scan the above QR code.

Upcoming Trips, Courses and Events

Wellington Section Trips

Ian Barnes has indicated he is keen to get a trip scheduled for 8-9 October with a preference for something in the top half of the South Island. Tapuae-o-Uenuku is a possibility but he's open to suggestions. Rental vehicle costs would be covered by the section so please contact Ian on ianbarnes@me.com if you're interested and to get in your vote for a destination by late September.

Over Labour Weekend there are two trips to choose from – decide if you'd like to go rock-climbing or alpine climbing.

We're also considering a section trip to climb Mt Aspiring in November. There will likely be a limit on numbers for this trip with skill and fitness level criteria to meet.

Keep an eye on our Facebook page for more details or email us on wellington@alpineclub.org.nz to let us know if you're keen to come along. Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When?	Where?
8-9 October	Tapuae-o-Uenuku / other top of the South Island destination
Labour Weekend	Rock-climbing trip to Payne's Ford - led by Eric Duggan
Labour Weekend	Alpine climbing trip – probable destination is Mt Hopeless, Nelson Lakes – led by Simon Williamson
November	Mt Aspiring

Auckland Section trip – space open to another section's member to join in:

4 day guided ski touring trip 29 August - 1 Sept.

We are looking for a fourth for our back-country guided ski trip on the south Island. We have three committed and booked, it is looking like it will be a great trip, and it would be great to get a fourth person to make most cost effective for all.

Leaving out of Queenstown, our target is to spend 4 days ski touring, focusing on putting down some turns on the South Island. We will make an assessment of where to go as the date approaches to take advantage of the best snow/weather conditions, but we are keen to go to Centennial/Pioneer/Tasman areas. The cost of the trip is expected to be around \$1500-1600 dollars for the 4 days. The trip currently has three members of the Auckland section but we are looking for a fourth, if you are interested please contact Steve Burgess: burge333@yahoo.com.

Reel Rock 2016



Tickets are now on sale for REEL ROCK 11.

Who doesn't enjoy watching climbing films with their climbing buddies on the big screen? Who doesn't delight in sitting in a cinema with non-climbing friends listening to them gasp in wonder and hoping that they assume that your climbing trips are basically the same as those on screen?

The Wellington section is showing Reel Rock 11: the latest collection of electrifying climbing films showcasing the sport's biggest stories and athletes. The five new films deliver edge-of-your-seat action, globe-trotting exploration, big laughs and true inspiration.

Wednesday 21 September at 6.15pm
Paramount Cinema, Courtenay Place

\$19 for Alpine Club members and students, \$14 for children, \$21 for everyone else. Tickets are available in person at the Paramount or [online](#).

Come along, get inspired, and support NZAC. Bring your non-climbing friends so you can show them what you do when you head off work early on Friday for those mysterious weekends away.

For further details, check out the [Reel Rock Tour website](#) and [join our Facebook event](#) for updates.

Trip Reports

Third time lucky

Words and photos by Peter Laurenson

In July 2014 a friend and I ventured down to Homer Hut in the Darran Mountains to see what the place was like and to learn from other climbers at the annual Otago Chapter climbing meet organised by Al Walker.



Near our turn around point on Talbot Ladder in July 2014.

During phone and email discussions with Al in the lead up to the meet we had identified a route, supposedly suitable for relative novices like me – a climb up the steep southwest flanks of Mount Crosscut, around the north side of that mountain to the ridge leading to Barrier Peak, then on to Barrier Knob. From there, a drop down to Gertrude Saddle, then up again to Traverse Pass. Then perhaps a quick side trip to Mount Talbot's summit, before continuing westward to Mount McPherson, before descending Talbot Ladder to Homer Saddle and out. A nice two day route starting and ending at Homer Hut. Or so I thought.

The thing is though, we had underestimated both the seriousness of the Darrans and the toughness of the locals who spend a lot of time in there. What is a nice easy route to these guys is a bridge too far for the likes of me – at least if attempted as one outing.

So, fast forward two winters and I was back at Homer Hut with a new climbing buddy, Piotr Nowak, who I met through the 2015 climbing meet. Piotr is a much stronger rock climber than me which, from my last two visits to Talbot Ladder, I knew would be very helpful. This time, unlike the last two, we were also blessed with a lovely weather window.



On Homer Saddle again in July 2016, sorting gear, with Talbot Ladder ahead.

Piotr and I arrived at Homer Hut on Friday afternoon. With high hopes, we organised all our gear and hit the hay early so we could be away by 6am – two hours before dawn. Our ambitions were now much more realistic than on my first visit. We would just attempt half my original objective – Homer Saddle, Talbot Ladder, Mount McPherson, Traverse Pass, Gertrude Saddle and out. Still a nice circuit, but not requiring any midwinter bivying and permitting a nice bottle of Shiraz back at the hut to finish.

From Homer Hut, it's just a two or so hour climb to Homer Saddle (1,375m). This time, under torchlight as we scrambled up the boulder field in McPherson Cirque, we encountered zero snow until about 1,450 metres. We arrived on Homer Saddle at dawn. Above, the dawn light revealed iced up rock and unconsolidated snow. In summer conditions Talbot Ladder is just a steep, exposed rock scramble, but with snow and ice and it required several pitches with yawning drops on both sides before we gained access to the much wider, more gradual snow ridge at about 1,700 metres. This lead to the summit of Mount McPherson (1,931m).



Beneath the summit of McPherson, with the Milford Road far below. Talbot ladder drops off the ridge on the right.

Once above Talbot Ladder we could relax and enjoy the ever more spectacular panoramic views which I had been coveting for three winters. On this lovely, calm morning I knew it had been worth the wait. As we cramponed up, we did as Al's guidebook suggested, keeping to the ridge rather than venturing out onto the snow field which, while it might offer a more direct route to Traverse Pass, conceals crevasses and avalanche danger.



McPherson summit view looking north and west (opposite direction to Talbot Ladder).

We reached the summit of McPherson about 1.30pm, enjoying a 360 degree panoramic view of precipitous ridges and peaks in every direction. This included our route dropping down and then up again to Traverse Pass (1,987m), just north of Mount Talbot (2,105m). Given the time and the large scale of our surroundings, we debated for a moment whether we should continue on or retrace our steps. Yeah nah: weather's great, let's go for it.

An abseil off the summit followed by a quick drop across a snow field had us thinking our progress would be quicker from now on. But a steep exposed ramp below Traverse Pass obliged us to get the rope back into action. Once on Traverse Pass it quickly became apparent why it is so named. You indeed need to traverse along eastwards to get past cliffs before you can drop down to Gertrude Saddle.



Climbing the steep section below Traverse Pass.

As we descended snow fields on the north side of the Pass, the sky began to take on the heavenly hues of a winter sunset. The going was easy until we hit the unseasonably high snowline again. Here the treacherously slippery rocky slabs became much more challenging. By the time we had cleared Gertrude Saddle (1,410m) it was nearly dark.



Checking the map as we realise we're not going to get all the way down before nightfall. Just right of bottom centre is Gertrude Saddle with Barrier Knob, Barrier Peak and Mount Crosscut out to the right

As the sun set at Black Lake, we decided to get the crampons off. In the darkness, we couldn't see all of the Teflon-slick black ice plastered all over the place. Hanging off the metal cable on a steep section just below the Black Lake was hairy enough, but the slabs below that were diabolical. One moment I was standing and the next flat on my back. Piotr actually took a 15 or so metre slide down the slabs, stopping only when he collided with a large boulder. Hmm, crampons back on!

We were glad to reach Homer Hut two hours after nightfall, having finally completed a circuit claimed by many to be the finest day walk in New Zealand. In summer apparently the whole circuit takes about 8 hours. Our winter effort took 14 hours.

The following two days remained clear with gave us enough time to do the other half of my original objective. Trouble was, our legs were so stiff after our effort (and the Crosscut bluffs looked so steep), that we decided to leave that one for another time. As I pondered how I'm not as young as I used to be, I rationalised that the Darrans are not a place to take lightly.



Just south of Gertrude Saddle, looking towards Milford Sound

For more images and trip map – Occasionalclimber.co.nz.

Beginner & Intermediate Snow-Craft Course Weekend

Words by Frances Watling

Photos by Herwin Bongers

Snow is an odd thing. Its starry flakes are so gentle and so orderly - a miracle of loveliness and perfection. But beauty is not always trustworthy; her character is mainly superficial, unstable. And so it is with the beauty of snow. You have to be pretty well acquainted with it if you are to get away with it for long.

These were the sentiments of Herman Buhl, the legendary Austrian mountaineer of the post-war years, from his auto-biography Nanga Parbat Pilgrimage. They also proved to be sadly poignant; Buhl fell to his death when a cornice collapsed underneath him on Chogolisa during a first ascent attempt in 1957.

It was with the express intent of learning more about the qualities of snow that on the weekend of 13th & 14th of August two snow-craft courses were run simultaneously at Whakapapa, Ruapehu. Twelve participants took part, supported by six instructors.

The beginner and intermediate snow-craft courses enable participants to learn and practice a range of skills relevant to safe travel across snow in the NZ Alpine environment. Led by experienced instructors the courses are platforms for sharing knowledge and personal experiences, and for participants to learn and test new skills.

The instructors explained that the purpose of the course is to teach students a repertoire of safe snow-climbing techniques. They pressed the point that after the course it is important for each participant to go out and practice these skills. The idea is to be able to use them as a set of default methods that they know to be safe. They should then build on this knowledge and be aware that the techniques covered on the course are not the only ways to do things. As each person's experience develops, they will be able to choose what methods work best for them.



Learning the finer skills of avalanche rescue.

On Saturday both groups started their courses inside the Manawatu Ski Lodge. As a combination of rain and driving sleet reigned outside, the groups covered the use of transceivers, some basic strategies for assessing avalanche risks and some rope-work. After lunch everyone kitted up and headed out, embracing the conditions. The visibility was poor for most of the afternoon with intermittent periods of heavy snowfall.

During the afternoon the Beginner Course made a simple navigation plan to complete a loop around the lodge. Covering this route they considered the basics of movement on snow without crampons. They built snow shelters, learnt how to carry out transceiver searches and put in some serious practice to master self-arrest techniques.

The Intermediate group spent time building snow anchors and then testing them to destruction. The group employed a variety of anchors and belay techniques including snow-bollards, T-slots, mid-clip snow-stakes and stompers. At times the visibility was minimal, which made for ideal conditions to discuss some of the difficulties of traveling in the mountain environment. At the end of the day the group practiced transceiver searches, with Shea Melville recording an impressively quick search time of 1 minute and 7 seconds.

Back in the lodge participants shared what they had learnt. Trevor Mordaunt explained that the day's activities had really opened his eyes to avalanche dangers. "I was totally unaware before the course that this was a consideration on this mountain."

Saturday night, after a great feed, Alex Waterworth gave the high level hut traverse a spirited attempt, sacrificing some skin along the route. To finish the day the whole hut, including those people not taking part in the two courses, watched the film 'Sherpa' in the main lounge. There were no surprises that the film provoked quite a bit of discussion.



Intermediate class: probes at the ready.



Ayolt, the pancake king.

On Sunday the conditions couldn't have been more different. The sky was blue and sunscreen was essential as the groups prepared to leave the lodge. Outside some spectacular icicles had formed around the building, curling upwards against gravity. The groups found that the snow conditions had changed significantly overnight.

A crispy ice layer now covered the 'rockslide' created by the Beginner group the previous day while they practiced their self-arrest techniques.

This provided the opportunity for the group to put on crampons and learn how to ascend and descend. Afterwards the group navigated their way to the Amphitheatre where they practiced movement skills, route selection and awareness of terrain hazards.

The Intermediate group gave attention to further developing their rope-work, as well as understanding and using communication protocols and setting up belays. The group demonstrated clear progress from the previous day. A short session on survival skills and navigation ended the training for the Intermediate group, while the Beginner course finished up with a snowball fight.

At the final debrief the groups shared what they had learnt over the two days. The general impression was that confidence had grown and each person had taken something positive away from the course. However this wasn't always about learning something new. Ryan Sixtus shared that he had developed an understanding of "what I've previously been doing right and wrong in the snow."



Alex with world's biggest stack of pancakes during Sunday bake-off.

Having observed significant progress amongst the students, there was a fair amount of encouragement for the groups to get back into the mountains and practice what they learnt. Simon Williamson, the course director, advised: "it is good to go out and practice but each person needs to set goals based on their own level of experience." He also mentioned that the section will be organizing a supported trip on the back of the course to encourage participants to go out independently while maintaining a low level of support.



Ayolt following up second.



High quality of alpine instruction course being demoed.

Jennifer Paverd, one of the students on the beginner course, summarized the weekend with “everything was new and exciting, really cool.” This was a pretty positive response considering she had spent some of her weekend being dangled by her feet, on her back, at the top of a snow slope, while someone prepared to throw an axe to her when they dropped her over the edge – a great technique to practice when venturing into the beautiful snow.



A great day for building and testing snow anchors and T-slots .

I say Kos-tuze-co, they say Koz-ee-os-co

Words and photos by Peter Laurenson

Well, what's in a name you might say? Ask those who live in W(h)anganui. And as for Mount Kosciuszko in the Snowy Mountains of New South Wales, saying its name might be the biggest challenge it offers.

Whether pronounced the Polish way or the Australian way, getting up to Australia's highest point (2,228m) isn't the most difficult alpine excursion around. I went up with my partner Cathy (who isn't a climber but appreciates grand scenery), two of my sons Ed and Will, my ex-climbing buddy (he defected to Canberra) Steve and his wife Theresa in the second week of the July school holidays.



Snowshoeing across a rolling landscape – enjoying a clearing in the weather

To be honest, we cheated – taking the Kosciuszko Express chairlift option from Thredbo up to 1,930 metres. From there it was just a six or so kilometer plod over rolling snow fields to the top. Even so, it was mid-winter and still pretty chilly – not conditions to take lightly, especially as we plodded through whiteout for much of the excursion. GPS is a wonderful thing – we used it lots, especially nearer the summit mound where we were in complete whiteout.



Nearing the summit in a whiteout

When gathering local intel back down at the Jindabyne visitor centre (Jindabyne is to Thredbo what Ohakune is to Turoa) we were strongly advised that snowshoes were essential. We were also advised not to even try the route if it was cloudy. Hmm, I do dislike that dumbing down to the lowest common denominator, cover-your-ar-se attitude that can so easily discourage people from giving things a go. I took the first recommendation on board and dismissed the second.

So off we went to suss out the best price for snowshoe hire. This was well worth the effort. After some haggling, our first quote came in at AUD240 – that's not a fair suck of the sav cobber. So we tried at the store next door and, without even haggling, got our six pairs for AUD120 - bonza!

The drive up to Thredbo from Jindabyne only took half an hour. But beware, in busy times and when there's snow on the road it can take several hours. We chose the second week of the Kiwi school holidays for a reason – it meant we were there the week AFTER the Aussie school holidays finished.

At Thredbo it was still busier than we'd expected, so it took a bit of queueing to get our ski IDs (at AUD4 each, a bit of a rip for international visitors who are not going to be back again anytime soon) and lift passes organised. Still, we were at the top of the lift with snowshoes installed by 10am. The thousand or so metres of boring, skier dodging plodding we avoided was well worth the AUD35 per adult.

There is actually a metal grid platform running almost the entire way from the top of the lift to the base of Kosciuszko's summit, but it was mostly covered by snow. So we kept an eye on the GPS as we plodded.

I must admit that the snowshoes were a good idea. It was the first time any of us had used them and it made things much easier. Tip for young players though, don't try to go backwards in them. I did when trying to get into a better spot for a photo and very quickly hit the deck – they are designed to constantly drop down at the back so that the fronts don't catch the snow.



Our only company for the entire day – a kite powered snowboarder – pretty cool

We had virtually the entire route to ourselves and it took about two and half hours for our little party to reach the summit. Our view was a rather fancy permanent cairn and lots of swirling cloud. But it didn't matter; we'd had a worthy little family adventure, given snowshoes a go and summited Australia. And besides, now there are just the six other easy summits on the seven summits list to go.



On top of Australia – 2,228 metres above the Great Barrier Reef. Beaudy Bruce

For more images and trip map – Occasionalclimber.co.nz.

Notices

Climbing injuries survey

Sam Terry, a student at the Southern Institute of Technology, is conducting survey on climbing injuries as part of a research project he is conducting which is a significant means tot achieving his bachelor of sport and exercise. Terry specifically chose climbing injuries as his passion is the outdoors and he hopes by understanding how and why injuries occur in climbing, he may be able to assist our community in reducing such injuries.

NZAC is quite keen for people to participate as our organization will be receiving a copy of the results. Please follow the link below and take part in the survey by **15th September!**

<https://www.surveymonkey.com/r/HGDW9YY>

Potton and Burton - 20 % discount to NZAC members

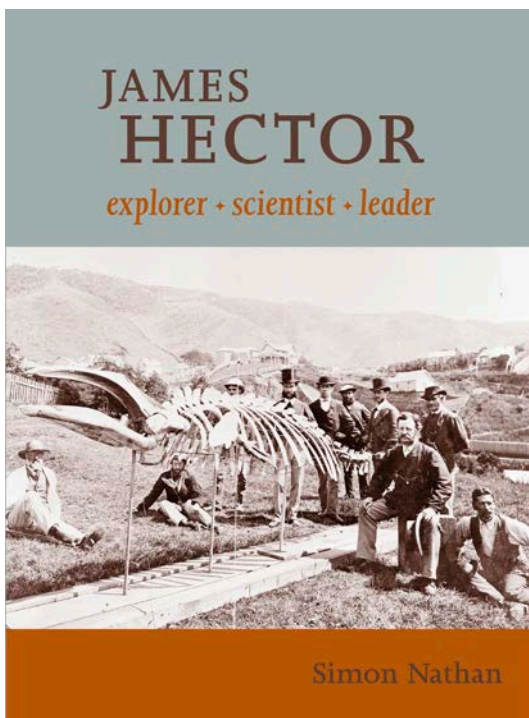
As new publications are released, specific titles will be made available to NZAC members at a 20% discount. The current offer and time limit to redeem the offer are detailed below. Information on the books' content may be found on the Potton and Burton website below.

Current Applicable titles:

James Hector: explorer; scientist; leader

Simon Nathan

ISBN 9781877480461 RRP \$45.00



Discount and discount code:

20% off RRP by quoting Discount Code (viewable when logged in)

Free Freight within New Zealand

Discount available until 31 December 2016

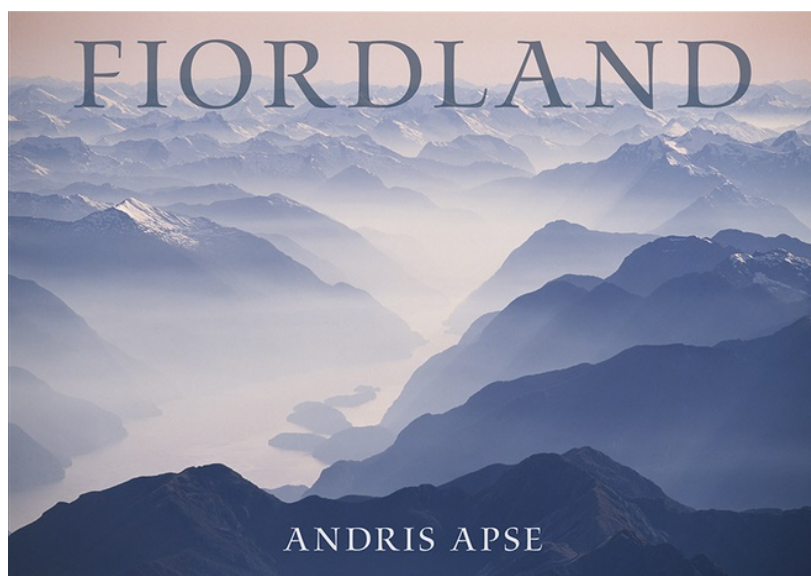
<https://alpineclub.org.nz/company/potton-and-burton/>

Fiordland

Andris Apse

ISBN Standard 9780947503161 RRP \$79.99 (standard edition)

ISBN Deluxe 9780947503178 RRP \$150.00 (deluxe edition)



Discount and discount code:

20% off RRP by quoting Discount Code (viewable when logged in)

Free Freight within New Zealand

Discount available 15 August - 31 December 2016

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/company/potton-and-burton-2/>

NZAC member discounted rates at DOC huts

A reminder to members that you need to have your active NZAC membership card with you when paying hut fees at DOC offices to obtain the discounted rates. DOC officials have no way to check your membership is active and are likely to insist on seeing your card to give you member rates. NZAC is not able to refund overpayments, so it is important to have your member card on you at the time of payment.

NZAC member online discounts

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/company/gnomes-alpine-sports/> 15% discount off full retail and workshop servicing

https://alpineclub.org.nz/ski_field/porters/ Porters have added a mid-week ski lift discount to their student rate for members

Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival Trip - Thursday 25 to Tuesday 30 August inclusive.

Jenny Cossey (Wellington Member) is organising a private trip to the Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival 2016. **This is not a supported NZAC Wellington Section or National Trip.** If you would like to attend with Jenny, further details are below.

This is the annual climbing meet of the Expedition Climbers Club Incorporated, bringing together a huge cross section of climbers from around NZ and the world. Beginners get to rub shoulders and share the rope with the top winter alpine climbers in NZ. Clinics, competitions, races and social gatherings advance and promote modern mixed climbing. Showcasing the new and existing route potential on NZ's most accessible multi-pitch winter training area: the Remarkables. Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing partnerships. Fundraising for the ECC Expedition Capital Fund.

For more information about the festival and what options are available see more at: <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/#!/about/> . By signing up to the festival you automatically become a member of the Expedition Climbers Club to help raise funds for NZ expeditions overseas. Festival registration is now open on a first come, first serve basis. Festival registration closes three weeks prior to the festival or whenever the clinic/general climbing allocation is full.

For more information about the trip please contact Jenny Cossey.

Please confirm your Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival registration and Wellington to Queenstown flight tickets to trip organiser Jenny Cossey by July 31st to confirm your attendance.

Contact Jenny on jennycossey1@gmail.com 021 072 1000

NZAC 2017 Climbing Camp

The Otago Section will be hosting the 2017 climbing camp that will be from Saturday 4th to Saturday 11th February. The Camp will be based at the Top Forks Hut in the Wilkin Valley. As it is a 12 hour walk into the Top Forks hut it is proposed that people attending the camp travel by helicopter from Makarora.

Top Forks hut is in a stunning alpine environment and there are several peaks within striking distance of the hut, many of them grade 1 climbs. Campers are expected to be self-contained with their own tent, cooking equipment, fuel and food. We will have access to the hut but not exclusive use. We will be providing some basic communal facilities such as a tarp shelter, dish-washing facilities, toilet tent, thermos and a mountain radio.

We will limit the number of people attending the camp to 40 so early registration is recommended. You can obtain additional information and a registration form from the NZAC website. There will be a modest registration fee and you are expected to pay for your helicopter or jet boat travel to and from the camp. Budget on \$170 each way to/from Top Forks for the helicopter or \$110 each way for jet boat access via Kerin Forks Hut. Note: Top Forks is still a 6 hr walk from Kerin Forks. An option is to fly in and jet boat out.

The camp is suitable for climbers of all levels of experience but you must be an Alpine club member to attend. If you do not have a climbing partner at the camp we will arrange for you to team up with other climbers.

If you require additional information contact Keith Moffat Ph 03 473-8903 Mob 0276644037 or e-mail Moffat.k172@gmail.com.

Wellington Section 2016 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Contact
Chairperson	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Co Chair	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Treasurer	Mark Leslie	027 338 4458
Secretary & Vertigo editor	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Patron	John Nankervis	
Other Committee Members	Aviette Musin	021 0299 5390
	Sharron Came	
	Gina Butson	
	Elisha Watson	
Rock Drill Overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 55 55 893

www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Twitter @NZACWellington



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www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$12
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$10

New routes every week*

\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012

New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through
better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



**HangDog Rock Climbing
Adventures**

453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181
info@hangdog.co.nz

www.hangdog.co.nz

i climb
.co.nz

Simond alpine equipment direct from the importer



Ocelot
\$115



MXC 820
\$230



Makalu
\$255



Caiman
\$230

all crampons include anti-balling plates
and crampon bag



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